with the Pi 2. The dominant operating system types for the Raspberry Pi are driven from the open source community and are one form or another of Linux. As most computer users know, Linux is an open source, free-to-use, customisable and powerful operating system. There are hundreds of different variations available for Linux, many of which work on the Raspberry Pi. These versions are called as distributions or distros.

Raspbian OS

As we mentioned earlier, the default OS for the Pi is called Raspbian which is actually a distro of the Debian OS, which comes bundled with many applications and development tools. It is the ideal OS for first time users of the Pi since it is designed with the Raspberry Pi hardware limitations in mind. This custom fit ensures superior performance and gets the most out of the hardware. It's also convenient to start with since its installation process is intuitive and fast. In addition to which, the bundled packages of applications allow the Raspberry Pi to be good-to-go with all essential tools ready at the time of initialisation. The OS also comes with full documentation and an active online community.

The Raspbian OS was created and developed with the Lightweight X11 Desktop Environment or LXDE and Openbox, as the windows manager, which makes it efficient and smooth. This setup ensures that the OS uses only the minimum resources allowing for faster and smoother performance. At its core, the Raspbian OS remains committed to the core ideals of education by the Raspberry Foundation. This is why the OS also comes with the basic tools like Scratch, which educate and train users in programming. But in function, it is as fully functional as any operating system, making it perfect for a desktop computing solution.

Arch Linux ARM

The Arch Linux distro is a far more advanced operating system for the Raspberry Pi. It has been in development for over a decade and is brilliant for its efficient use of minimal resources. The elegance of the OSes design and speed are lauded web-wide, such as its less than 10 second boot up rate. The Arch Linux ARM is a port designed specifically for the Raspberry Pi and offers the user full control over the operating system and is very light on the hardware. But with all this control and speed, it sacrifices user friendliness.

In its default state, the Arch Linux ARM doesn't come with a graphical user interface. It presents only a command prompt on booting from which